

recommended in this patient population.

- Additional cautions for use in adjuvant treatment of breast cancer.

Complicated neutropenia

For patients who experience complicated neutropenia (prolonged neutropenia, febrile neutropenia or infection), G-CSF and dose reduction should be considered.

Gastrointestinal reactions

Symptoms such as early abdominal pain and tenderness, fever, diarrhea, with or without neutropenia, may be early manifestations of serious gastrointestinal toxicity and should be evaluated and treated promptly.

Congestive heart failure

Patients should be monitored for symptoms of congestive heart failure during therapy and during the follow up period.

Leukemia

In the Docetaxel, doxorubicin and cyclophosphamide (TAC) treated patients, the risk of delayed myelodysplasia or myeloid leukemia requires haematological follow-up.

Patients with 4+ nodes

The benefit/risk ratio for TAC in patients with 4+ nodes was not defined fully at the interim analysis.

Interactions with other medicaments

Docetaxel is metabolised by the cytochrome P450 isoenzyme CYP3A4 and use with inducers or inhibitors or other substrates of this enzyme may affect exposure to docetaxel. It should be given with caution to patients taking strong CYP3A4 inhibitors including.

HIV-protease inhibitors such as ritonavir, and azole antifungals like ketoconazole or itraconazole.

Concurrent use of rotavirus vaccine and chemotherapeutic agents may result in an increased risk of infection by the live vaccine. Hence it is contraindicated.

Concurrent use of docetaxel and thalidomide may result in an increased risk of venous thromboembolism.

Concurrent use of live vaccines and chemotherapeutic agents may result in an increased risk of infection by the live vaccine.

Concurrent use of docetaxel and doxorubicin may result in cholestatic jaundice and pseudomembranous colitis.

Concurrent use of docetaxel and itraconazole may result in an increased risk of docetaxel toxicity.

Concurrent use of docetaxel and the following may result in an increased risk of docetaxel toxicity (anemia, leukopenia, thrombocytopenia, fever, diarrhea).

- erythromycin
- terfenadine
- troleandomycin
- telithromycin
- indinavir
- nefazodone
- atazanavir
- nelfinavir
- clarithromycin
- cyclosporine
- ketoconazole
- voriconazole
- ritonavir

Concurrent use of cisplatin and docetaxel may result in increased risk of neuropathy.

Concurrent use of docetaxel and sorafenib may result in increased docetaxel exposure and plasma concentrations

Concurrent use of docetaxel and quinupristin/dalfopristin may result in an increased risk of docetaxel toxicity (neutropenia, anemia, neuropathy).

Concurrent use of docetaxel and doxorubicin hydrochloride liposome may result in increase in doxorubicin exposure.

Concurrent use of docetaxel and grapefruit juice may result in increased docetaxel exposure

Pregnancy and lactation

Pregnancy

In general, antineoplastic agents when given during the first trimester are believed to cause increases in the risk of congenital malformations, but when given during the second or third trimesters are believed to only increase the risk of growth retardation. Depending upon the nature of the malignancy, the progression of the disease and how advanced the gestation, chemotherapy can, in some cases, be deferred allowing fetal maturation to occur, and in some cases, earlier-than-term delivery may provide an acceptable compromise between maternal and fetal risk.

Due to the potential for fetotoxicity and maternal toxicity demonstrated in animal studies and the lack of adequate, well-controlled human studies, docetaxel must not be used during pregnancy.

Women of childbearing potential should be instructed to avoid pregnancy during docetaxel therapy and to inform the treating physician immediately should this occur. If docetaxel therapy is initiated in a pregnant woman or if a woman becomes pregnant while receiving docetaxel treatment, she should be apprised of the potential harm to the fetus and of the possible risk of losing the pregnancy.

Lactation

It is not known whether docetaxel is excreted into human breast milk and the potential for adverse effects in the nursing infant from docetaxel exposure is unknown. Due of the potential for adverse effects in nursing infants, a decision should be made whether to discontinue nursing or to discontinue docetaxel, taking into consideration the importance of the drug to the mother.

Side effects

Adverse Effects / Undesirable Effects

Common

- Cardiovascular: Edema, Vasodilatation
- Dermatologic: Alopecia, Disorder of nail, Disorder of skin AND/OR subcutaneous tissue, Nail changes, Pruritus, Rash
- Gastrointestinal: Diarrhea, Nausea, Stomatitis, Vomiting
- Hematologic: Anemia, Leukopenia, Neutropenia
- Neurologic: Asthenia, Neuropathy
- Reproductive: Amenorrhoea
- Other: Fever of unknown origin, weight gain

Serious

- Cardiovascular: Edema (Severe)
- Dermatologic: Stevens-Johnson syndrome, Toxic epidermal necrolysis
- Gastrointestinal: Colitis
- Hematologic: Anemia, less than 8 g/dL, Febrile neutropenia, Leukopenia, less than 1000 cells/mm(3), Neutropenia, less than 500 cells/mm(3), Thrombocytopenia
- Hepatic: Hepatotoxicity
- Immunologic: Anaphylaxis (rare)
- Renal: Renal failure
- Respiratory: Interstitial pneumonia, Pulmonary embolism
- Other: Infectious disease

Martindale, Micromedex

- Rare cases of ototoxicity, hearing impairment or loss have occurred.
- Very rare cases of acute myeloid leukaemia and myelodysplastic syndrome have been reported with combination chemotherapy regimens containing docetaxel; haematological follow-up may be required.

Symptoms and Treatment of over dose

Symptoms

Overdose effects are expected to be an extension of adverse events and include bone marrow suppression, peripheral neurotoxicity, and mucositis.

Mild to moderate toxicity: Early symptoms may include: nausea, vomiting and diarrhea.

Severe toxicity: Myelosuppression (neutropenia and febrile neutropenia) is likely to develop and can be severe. Anemia and thrombocytopenia may develop. Other potentially serious events include: liver function impairment; fluid retention leading to edema, dyspnea, cardiac tamponade, or pleural effusion; and severe stomatitis. Patients with abnormal liver function are at increased risk of toxicity.

Treatment

Treatment is primarily symptomatic and supportive, there is no antidote. Colony stimulating factor (filgrastim or sargramostim) should be initiated as soon as possible. Patients with severe neutropenia should be in protective isolation. Platelet and red cell transfusions may be necessary. In case of emesis, aggressively treat with antiemetics and fluid and electrolyte replacement as indicated. Closely monitor patients for hypotension, bradycardia, and other cardiac dysrhythmias. Monitor liver enzymes and renal function.

Incompatibilities

This medicinal product must not be mixed with other medicinal products except those mentioned.

Storage condition

Storage condition for unopened vial: Store below 30°C. If the vials are stored under refrigeration (2°C to 8°C), allow the required number of boxes of Docetaxel concentrate for solution for infusion to stand below 25°C for 5 minutes before use.

Store in the original package in order to protect from light.

Storage condition with dilution

0.9% w/v Sodium Chloride

Store up to 6 hours at room temperature 25°C and up to 24 hours when stored between 2 to 8°C into the infusion bag.

5% w/v Dextrose Injection

Store up to 6 hours at room temperature 25°C and up to 24 hours when stored between 2 to 8°C into the infusion bag.

Shelf Life

Unopened vial: 2 years

After opening of the vial:

Each vial is for single use and should be used immediately after opening. If not used immediately, in-use storage times and conditions are the responsibility of the user.

Once added to the infusion bag:

From a microbiological point of view, reconstitution/dilution must take place in controlled and aseptic conditions and the medicinal product should be used immediately. If not used immediately, in-use storage times and conditions are the responsibility of the user.

Once added as recommended into the infusion bag, the docetaxel infusion solution, if stored below 25°C, is stable for 6 hours. It should be used within 6 hours (including the one hour infusion IV administration).

In addition, physical and chemical in-use stability of the infusion solution prepared as recommended has been demonstrated in PVC bags up to 24 hours when stored between 2 to 8°C. Docetaxel infusion solution is supersaturated, therefore may crystallize over time. If crystals appear, the solution must no longer be used and shall be discarded.

Presentation

Concentrate for solution for infusion 20 mg/0.5 ml is packaged in clear glass vials (Type I) with 5 ml nominal capacity with reinforced Non PVC base which are stoppered with rubber plugs, crimped with seals and tampered with flip-off tops. Each Vial is packed into secondary carton along with a package insert.

Concentrate for solution for infusion 80 mg/2.0 ml is packaged in clear glass vials (Type I) with 15 ml nominal capacity with reinforced Non PVC base which are stoppered with rubber plugs, crimped with seals and tampered with flip-off tops. Each Vial is packed into secondary carton along with a package insert.

Product Registration Holder:

Unimed Sdn Bhd
53, Jalan Tembaga SD 5/2B, Bandar Sri Damansara, 52200, Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

Manufactured by :

VENUS REMEDIES LIMITED

Hill Top Industrial Estate, Jharmajri, EPIP, Phase-I (Extn.), Bhatoli Kalan, Baddi, Distt. Solan, Himachal Pradesh-173 205 (INDIA)

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B81/DC20/0844, B81/DC80/0845



DOXOL™

Docetaxel 20mg/0.5ml Concentrate for Solution for Infusion

Docetaxel 80mg/2ml Concentrate for Solution for Infusion

Name and Strength of Active Substance(s)

Each ml of concentrate contains:

Docetaxel (as anhydrous) 40mg

Ethanol (as anhydrous) 326mg

Description and Composition:

DOXOL DOCETAXEL 20MG/0.5ML CONCENTRATE FOR SOLUTION FOR INFUSION

Docetaxel concentrate for solution for infusion 20 mg/0.5 ml is a yellow to pale yellow solution

Description after Dilution

Dilution in NaCl Injection (0.9 % w/v) - A clear colourless to slightly pale yellow solution

Dilution in Dextrose Injection (5.0 % w/v) - A clear colourless to slightly pale yellow solution

DOXOL DOCETAXEL 80MG/2.0ML CONCENTRATE FOR SOLUTION FOR INFUSION

Docetaxel concentrate for solution for infusion 80 mg/2.0 ml is a yellow to pale yellow solution

Description after Dilution

Dilution in NaCl Injection (0.9 % w/v) - A clear colourless to slightly pale yellow solution

Dilution in Dextrose Injection (5.0 % w/v) - A clear colourless to slightly pale yellow solution

Pharmacodynamics

Docetaxel is a semisynthetic analogue of paclitaxel.

Systemic: Docetaxel is an antimitotic agent. It binds to free tubulin, then promotes the polymerization of tubulin into stable microtubules and inhibits microtubule disassembly, resulting in blockade of cellular mitotic and interphase functions and, consequently, in inhibition of cell division. Unlike paclitaxel and other spindle poisons in clinical use, docetaxel does not alter the number of protofilaments in the bound microtubules.

The mechanisms by which resistance to docetaxel occurs are not completely understood. Studies have shown that docetaxel is active against several tumor cell lines overexpressing the multidrug resistance gene. Also, cross-resistance between docetaxel and paclitaxel does not occur consistently. Several *in vitro* and *in vivo* studies have shown that docetaxel has only moderate immunosuppressive activity.

Pharmacokinetics

The kinetic profile of docetaxel is dose independent and consistent with a three-compartment pharmacokinetic model. The late phase is due, in part, to a relatively slow efflux of docetaxel from the peripheral compartment.

Distribution

Intravenous dosage docetaxel is rapidly distributed to body tissues. Docetaxel is more than 95% bound to plasma proteins.

Metabolism

It is extensively metabolized via hepatic cytochrome P450 isoenzyme CYP3A4

Excretion

Docetaxel is excreted chiefly in the faeces as metabolites. Only about 6% of a dose is excreted in urine. The terminal elimination half-life is about 11 hours. Clearance is reduced in hepatic impairment.

Indications

Breast Cancer:

- Docetaxel in combination with doxorubicin and cyclophosphamide is indicated for the adjuvant treatment of patients with operable node-positive breast cancer.

- Docetaxel in combination with doxorubicin is indicated for the treatment of patients with locally advanced or metastatic breast cancer who have not previously received cytotoxic therapy for this condition.

- Docetaxel in combination with capecitabine is indicated for the treatment of patients with locally advanced or metastatic breast cancer after failure of cytotoxic chemotherapy. Previous therapy should have included an anthracycline.

- Docetaxel monotherapy is indicated for the treatment of patients with locally advanced or metastatic breast cancer in whom previous therapy has failed. Prior therapy should have included an anthracycline unless clinically contraindicated.

Non-Small Cell Lung Cancer:

- Docetaxel is indicated for the treatment of patients with locally advanced or metastatic non-small cell lung cancer even after failure of platinum-based chemotherapy.

- Docetaxel in combination with cisplatin is indicated for the treatment of patients with unresectable, locally advanced or metastatic non-small cell lung cancer, in patients who have not previously received chemotherapy for this condition.

- Docetaxel in combination with carboplatin represents a treatment option to cisplatin-based therapy.

Ovarian Cancer:

- Docetaxel is indicated for the treatment of metastatic carcinoma of the ovary after failure of first-line or subsequent chemotherapy.

Squamous Cell Carcinoma of the Head and Neck:

- Docetaxel is indicated as monotherapy in the treatment of patients with recurrent and/or metastatic squamous cell carcinoma of the head and neck after failure of a previous chemotherapy regimen.

Prostate Cancer:

- Docetaxel in combination with prednisone or prednisolone is indicated for the treatment of patients with hormone refractory metastatic prostatic cancer.

Gastric Adenocarcinoma:

- Docetaxel in combination with cisplatin and 5-fluorouracil is indicated for the treatment of patients with metastatic gastric adenocarcinoma, including adenocarcinoma of the gastroesophageal junction, who have not received prior chemotherapy for metastatic disease.

Head and neck cancer:

- Docetaxel in combination with cisplatin and 5-fluorouracil is indicated for the induction treatment of patients with inoperable locally advanced squamous cell carcinoma of the head and neck.

The use of docetaxel should be confined to units specialized in the administration of cytotoxic chemotherapy and it should only be administered under the supervision of a physician qualified in the use of anticancer chemotherapy.

Recommended dose

For breast, non-small cell lung, gastric, and head and neck cancers, premedication consisting of an oral corticosteroid, such as dexamethasone 16 mg per day (e.g. 8 mg BID) for 3 days starting 1 day prior to docetaxel administration, unless contraindicated, can be used. Prophylactic G-CSF may be used to mitigate the risk of hematological toxicities. For prostate cancer, given the concurrent use of prednisone or prednisolone the recommended premedication regimen is oral dexamethasone 8 mg, 12 hours, 3 hours and 1 hour before the docetaxel infusion.

Docetaxel is administered as a one-hour infusion every three weeks.

Breast cancer

In the adjuvant treatment of operable node-positive breast cancer, the recommended dose of docetaxel is 75 mg/m² administered 1-hour after doxorubicin 50 mg/m² and cyclophosphamide 500 mg/m² every 3 weeks for 6 cycles. For the treatment of patients with locally advanced or metastatic breast cancer, the recommended dosage of docetaxel is 100 mg/m² in monotherapy. In first-line treatment, docetaxel 75 mg/m² is given in combination therapy with doxorubicin (50 mg/m²).

In combination with capecitabine, the recommended dose of docetaxel is 75 mg/m² every three weeks, combined with capecitabine at 1250 mg/m² twice daily (within 30 minutes after a meal) for 2 weeks followed by 1- week rest period. For capecitabine dose calculation according to body surface area, see capecitabine summary of product characteristics.

Non-small cell lung cancer

In chemotherapy naive patients treated for non-small cell lung cancer, the recommended dose regimen is docetaxel 75 mg/m² immediately followed by cisplatin 75 mg/m² over 30-60 minutes. For treatment after failure of prior platinum-based chemotherapy, the recommended dosage is 75 mg/m² as a single agent.

Prostate cancer

The recommended dose of docetaxel is 75 mg/m². Prednisone or prednisolone 5 mg orally twice daily is administered continuously.

Gastric adenocarcinoma

The recommended dose of docetaxel is 75 mg/m² as a 1 hour infusion, followed by cisplatin 75 mg/m², as a 1 to 3 hour infusion (both on day 1 only), and followed by 5-fluorouracil 750 mg/m² per day given as a 24-hour continuous infusion for 5 days, starting at the end of the cisplatin infusion. Treatment is repeated every three weeks. Patients must receive premedication with antiemetics and appropriate hydration for cisplatin administration. Prophylactic G-CSF should be used to mitigate the risk of hematological toxicities.

Head and neck cancer

Patients must receive premedication with antiemetics and appropriate hydration (prior to and after cisplatin administration). Prophylactic G-CSF may be used to mitigate the risk of haematological toxicities. All patients on the docetaxel-containing arm of the TAX 323 and TAX 324 studies, received prophylactic antibiotics.

- o Induction chemotherapy followed by radiotherapy (TAX 323)

For the induction treatment of inoperable locally advanced squamous cell carcinoma of the head and neck (SCCHN), the recommended dose of docetaxel is 75 mg/m² as a 1 hour infusion followed by cisplatin 75 mg/m² over 1 hour, on day one, followed by 5-fluorouracil as a continuous infusion at 750 mg/m² per day for five days. This regimen is administered every 3 weeks for 4 cycles. Following chemotherapy, patients should receive radiotherapy.

- o Induction chemotherapy followed by chemo radiotherapy (TAX 324)

For the induction treatment of patients with locally advanced (technically unresectable, low probability of surgical cure, and aiming at organ preservation) squamous cell carcinoma of the head and neck (SCCHN), the recommended dose of docetaxel is 75 mg/m² as a 1 hour intravenous infusion on day 1, followed by cisplatin 100 mg/m² administered as a 30-minute to 3-hour infusion, followed by 5-fluorouracil 1000 mg/m²/day as a continuous infusion from day 1 to day 4. This regimen is administered every 3 weeks for 3 cycles. Following chemotherapy, patients should receive chemo radiotherapy.

For cisplatin and 5-fluorouracil dose modifications, see the corresponding summary of product characteristics.

Ovarian Cancer

The recommended dosage is 100mg/m² administered as one hour infusion every three weeks. When use in combination, docetaxel is administered at the recommended dosage of 75 mg/m².

Squamous Cell Carcinoma of the Head and Neck

The recommended dosage is 100mg/m² administered as one hour infusion every three weeks. When use in combination, docetaxel is administered at the recommended dosage of 75 mg/m².

Dosage adjustment during treatment

General

Docetaxel should be administered when the neutrophil count is =1,500 cells/mm³. In patients who experienced either febrile neutropenia, neutrophil < 500 cells/mm³ for more than one week, severe or cumulative cutaneous reactions or severe peripheral neuropathy during docetaxel therapy, the dose of docetaxel should be reduced from 100mg/m² to 75mg/m² and/or from 75 to 60mg/m². If the

patient continues to experience these reactions at 60mg/m², the treatment should be discontinued.

Adjuvant therapy for breast cancer

In patients who received adjuvant therapy for breast cancer and who experienced complicated neutropenia (including prolonged neutropenia, febrile neutropenia, or infection), it was recommended to use G-CSF to provide prophylactic coverage (eg. Day 4 to 11) in all subsequent cycles. Patients who continued to experience this reaction should remain on G-CSF and have their docetaxel dose reduced to 60mg/m².

However, in clinical practice neutropenia could occur earlier. Thus the use of G-CSF should be considered function of the neutropenic risk of the patient and current recommendations. Patients who experience Grade 3 or 4 stomatitis should have their dose decreased to 60mg/m².

In combination with cisplatin

For patients who are dosed initially at docetaxel 75mg/m² in combination with cisplatin and whose nadir of platelet count during the previous course of therapy is <25000 cells/mm³, or in patients who experience febrile neutropenia, or in patients with serious non-hematologic toxicities, the docetaxel dosage in subsequent cycles should be reduced to 65mg/m². For cisplatin dosage adjustments, see manufacturer's summary of product characteristics.

In combination with capecitabine:

For capecitabine dose modifications, see capecitabine summary of product characteristics.

For patients developing the first appearance of a Grade 2 toxicity, which persists at the time of the next docetaxel /capecitabine treatment, delay treatment until resolved to Grade 0-1, and resume at 100% of the original dose.

For patients developing the second appearance of a Grade 2 toxicity, or the first appearance of a Grade 3 toxicity, at any time during the treatment cycle, delay treatment until resolved to Grade 0-1, then resume treatment with docetaxel 55mg/m².

For any subsequent appearances of toxicities, or any Grade 4 toxicities, discontinue the docetaxel dose.

In Combination with Cisplatin and 5-fluorouracil:

If an episode of febrile neutropenia, prolonged neutropenia or neutropenic infection occurs despite G-CSF use, the docetaxel dose should be reduced from 75 to 60 mg/m². If subsequent episodes of complicated neutropenia occur the docetaxel dose should be reduced from 60 to 45 mg/m². In case of Grade 4 thrombocytopenia the docetaxel dose should be reduced from 75 to 60 mg/m². Patients should not be retreated with subsequent cycles of docetaxel until neutrophils recover to a level > 1,500 cells/mm³ and platelets recover to a level > 100,000 cells/mm³. Discontinue treatment if these toxicities persist.

Recommended dose modifications for gastrointestinal toxicities in patients treated with docetaxel in combination with cisplatin and 5-fluorouracil (5-FU):

Toxicity	Dosage adjustment
Diarrhoea grade 3	First episode: reduce 5-FU dose by 20%. Second episode: then reduce docetaxel dose by 20%.
Diarrhoea grade 4	First episode: reduce docetaxel and 5-FU doses by 20%. Second episode: discontinue treatment.
Stomatitis/mucositis grade 3	First episode: reduce 5-FU dose by 20%. Second episode: stop 5-FU only, at all subsequent cycles. Third episode: reduce docetaxel dose by 20%.
Stomatitis/mucositis grade 4	First episode: stop 5-FU only, at all subsequent cycles. Second episode: reduce docetaxel dose by 20%.

For cisplatin and 5-fluorouracil dosage adjustments, see manufacturers' summary of product characteristics.

In patients who received an induction treatment with docetaxel for inoperable locally advanced squamous SCCHN and who experienced complicated neutropenia (including prolonged neutropenia, febrile neutropenia, or infection), it was recommended to use G-CSF to provide prophylactic coverage (eg, day 6-15) in all subsequent cycles.

Special populations

Patients with Hepatic Impairment

Based on pharmacokinetic data with docetaxel at 100 mg/m² as single agent, patients who have both elevations of transaminase (ALT and/or AST) greater than 1.5 times the upper limit of the normal range (ULN) and alkaline phosphatase greater than 2.5 times the ULN, the recommended dose of docetaxel is 75 mg/m² (see sections Special Warnings and Precautions for Use and Pharmacokinetic Properties). For those patients with serum bilirubin > ULN and/or ALT and AST > 3.5 times the ULN associated with alkaline phosphatase > 6 times the ULN, no dose reduction can be recommended and docetaxel should not be used unless strictly indicated.

In combination with cisplatin and 5-fluorouracil for the treatment of patients with gastric adenocarcinoma, the pivotal clinical study excluded patients with ALT and/or AST > 1.5 x ULN associated with alkaline phosphatase > 2.5 x ULN, and bilirubin > 1 x ULN; for these patients, no dose-reductions can be recommended and docetaxel should not be used unless strictly indicated. No data are available in patients with hepatic impairment treated by docetaxel in combination in the other indications.

Paediatric Population

The safety and efficacy of DOXOL in nasopharyngeal carcinoma in children aged 1 month to less than 18 years have not been established.

There is no relevant use of DOXOL in the Paediatric population in the indications breast cancer, non-small cell lung cancer, prostate cancer, gastric carcinoma and head and neck cancer, not including type II and III less differentiated nasopharyngeal carcinoma.

Elderly Patients

Based on a population pharmacokinetic analysis, there are no special instructions for use in the elderly.

In combination with capecitabine, for patients 60 years of age or more, a starting dose reduction of capecitabine to 75% is recommended (see capecitabine summary of product characteristics).

Preparation for the intravenous administration

Preparation of the infusion solution

Each vial is of single use and should be used immediately

DO NOT use other docetaxel medicinal products consisting of 2 vials (concentrate and solvent) with this medicinal product (Docetaxel 20 mg/0.5 ml & 80 mg/2 ml concentrate for solution for infusion, which contains only 1 vial).

Docetaxel 20 mg/0.5 ml & 80 mg/2 ml concentrate for solution for infusion requires NO prior dilution with a solvent and is ready to add to the infusion solution.

Unopened Vials are stored below 30°C. If the vials are stored under refrigeration (2°C – 8°C), allow the required number of boxes of Docetaxel concentrate for solution for infusion to stand below 25°C for 5 minutes before use.

More than one vial of Docetaxel concentrate for solution for infusion may be necessary to obtain the required dose for the patient. Aseptically withdraw the required amount of Docetaxel concentrate for solution for infusion using a calibrated syringe.

The required volume of Docetaxel 20 mg/0.5 ml & 80 mg/2 ml concentrate for solution for infusion must be injected via a single injection (one shot) into a 250 ml infusion bag or bottle containing either 5% glucose solution or sodium chloride 9 mg/ml (0.9%) solution for infusion.

If a dose greater than 200 mg of docetaxel is required, use a larger volume of the infusion vehicle so that a concentration of 0.74 mg/ml docetaxel is not exceeded.

Mix the infusion bag or bottle manually using a rocking motion.

The infusion bag solution should be used within 6 hours below 25°C including the one hour infusion to the patient or used within 24-hours when stored between 2 to 8°C in the infusion bag.

As with all parenteral products, Docetaxel infusion solution should be visually inspected prior to use, solutions containing a precipitate should be discarded.

Any unused product or waste material should be disposed of in accordance with local requirements.

If Docetaxel concentrate or infusion solution should come into contact with skin, wash immediately and thoroughly with soap and water. If Docetaxel concentrate or infusion solution should come into contact with mucous membranes, wash immediately and thoroughly with water.

Mode of administration

Intravenous Administration

Contraindication

- o Hypersensitivity reactions to the active substance or to any of the excipients
- o Docetaxel should not be used in patients with baseline neutrophil counts of <1,500 cells/mm³
- o Docetaxel should not be used in pregnant or breast-feeding women
- o Docetaxel should not be used in patients with severe liver impairment since there is no data available
- o Contraindications for other medicinal products also apply, when combined with docetaxel

Warning and precautions

CAUTION: CYTOTOXIC AGENT

- o Treatment-related mortality has been reported; increased risk in patients with abnormal liver function, receiving higher doses, and with non-small cell lung carcinoma and a history of prior treatment with platinum-based chemotherapy who receive docetaxel as a single agent at a dose of 100 mg/m(2)
- o Concomitant use with CYP3A4 inhibitors should be avoided; if coadministration with a potent CYP3A4 inhibitor is necessary, closely monitor patients for toxicity and consider a docetaxel dosage adjustment
- o Severe thrombocytopenia has occurred; monitor blood cell counts frequently; do not retreat with subsequent cycles until the platelet count is greater than 100,000 cells/mm(3)
- o Severe (grade 4) neutropenia has been reported, with some cases associated with infection; monitor blood cell counts frequently and for signs of febrile neutropenia or neutropenic infections; dose reduction or therapy discontinuation may be warranted; do not retreat with subsequent cycles until the neutrophil count is greater than 1500 cells/mm(3)
- o In patients treated with docetaxel in combination with cisplatin and 5-fluorouracil (TCF), febrile neutropenia and neutropenic infection occurred at lower rates when patients received prophylactic GCSF. Patients treated with TCF should receive prophylactic G-CSF to mitigate the risk of complicated neutropenia (febrile neutropenia, prolonged neutropenia or neutropenic infection). Patients receiving TCF should be closely monitored.
- o Observe patients closely for hypersensitivity reactions especially during the first and second infusions. Hypersensitivity reactions may occur within a few minutes following the initiation of the infusion of docetaxel. Flushing or localised cutaneous reactions do not require interruption of therapy. However, severe reactions, such as severe hypotension, bronchospasm or generalised rash/erythema require immediate discontinuation of docetaxel and appropriate therapy. Patients who have developed severe hypersensitivity reactions should not be re-challenged with docetaxel.
- o Cutaneous toxicity (eg, localized erythema of the extremities with edema followed by desquamation) has occurred; dose reduction or therapy discontinuation may be warranted if severe skin toxicity develops
- o Severe fluid retention (eg, peripheral edema, generalized edema, pleural effusion, and ascites) has occurred; pretreatment with oral corticosteroids recommended prior to each dose
- o Elderly patients (aged 65 yr or older); higher incidence of serious adverse events compared with younger patients
- o Hepatic impairment; increased risk of severe or life-threatening toxicities; do not use in patients in patients with a bilirubin level greater than the ULN or SGOT and/or SGPT levels greater than 1.5 x ULN concomitant with an alkaline phosphatase (AP) level greater than 2.5 x ULN; monitor LFTs prior to each treatment cycle; dosage adjustment recommended for LFT elevations during treatment; discontinue treatment in patients who develop AST/ALT levels greater than 5 x ULN and/or AP level greater than 5 x ULN.
- o Severe neurosensory symptoms (eg, paresthesia, dyesthesia, pain) have been reported; dose reduction or therapy discontinuation may be warranted.
- o Contraceptive measures must be taken during and for at least three months after cessation of therapy.
- o Acute myeloid leukemia has been reported rarely in patients with breast cancer who received adjuvant therapy with docetaxel, doxorubicin, and cyclophosphamide; hematological follow-up